KATSUSHIKA HOKUSAI

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Read about the artist. Answer the questions in full sentences. Then complete the drawing task at the bottom.

MEET THE ARTIST

Katsushika Hokusai was born in 1760 in Edo, the city now called Tokyo, in Japan. He made woodblock prints: the artist draws the picture, a carver cuts it into blocks of wood, one block for each colour, and a printer presses the inked blocks onto paper so that many copies can be made. Hokusai is most famous for a set of prints called Thirty-six Views of Mount Fuji. In the best known, The Great Wave off Kanagawa, an enormous wave with claw-like foam curls over three boats, while the snowy mountain sits small and calm in the distance. He used a new deep blue ink imported from Europe. Hokusai also filled fifteen books of sketches, the Hokusai Manga, with people, animals, plants and ghosts. He changed his artist name about thirty times and worked until his death in 1849, aged 88.

1. Where was Hokusai born, and what is that city called today?

2. Explain how a woodblock print is made.

3. What is the name of his famous set of prints?

4. Describe what happens in The Great Wave off Kanagawa.

5. What are the Hokusai Manga?

YOUR TURN

Draw like Hokusai: a giant wave filling most of the box, with fingers of white foam, and a tiny calm mountain far behind it. Use only blue, white and one other colour, and outline every shape with a firm dark line.

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KATSUSHIKA HOKUSAI ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

MEET THE ARTIST

1. Edo, Japan; it is now called Tokyo.

2. The artist draws the picture, a carver cuts it into wooden blocks (one per colour) and a printer presses the inked blocks onto paper to make many copies.

3. Thirty-six Views of Mount Fuji.

4. An enormous wave with claw-like foam curls over three boats, while Mount Fuji sits small and calm in the distance.

5. Fifteen books of sketches of people, animals, plants and ghosts.

YOUR TURN

Drawing task; no single answer.

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